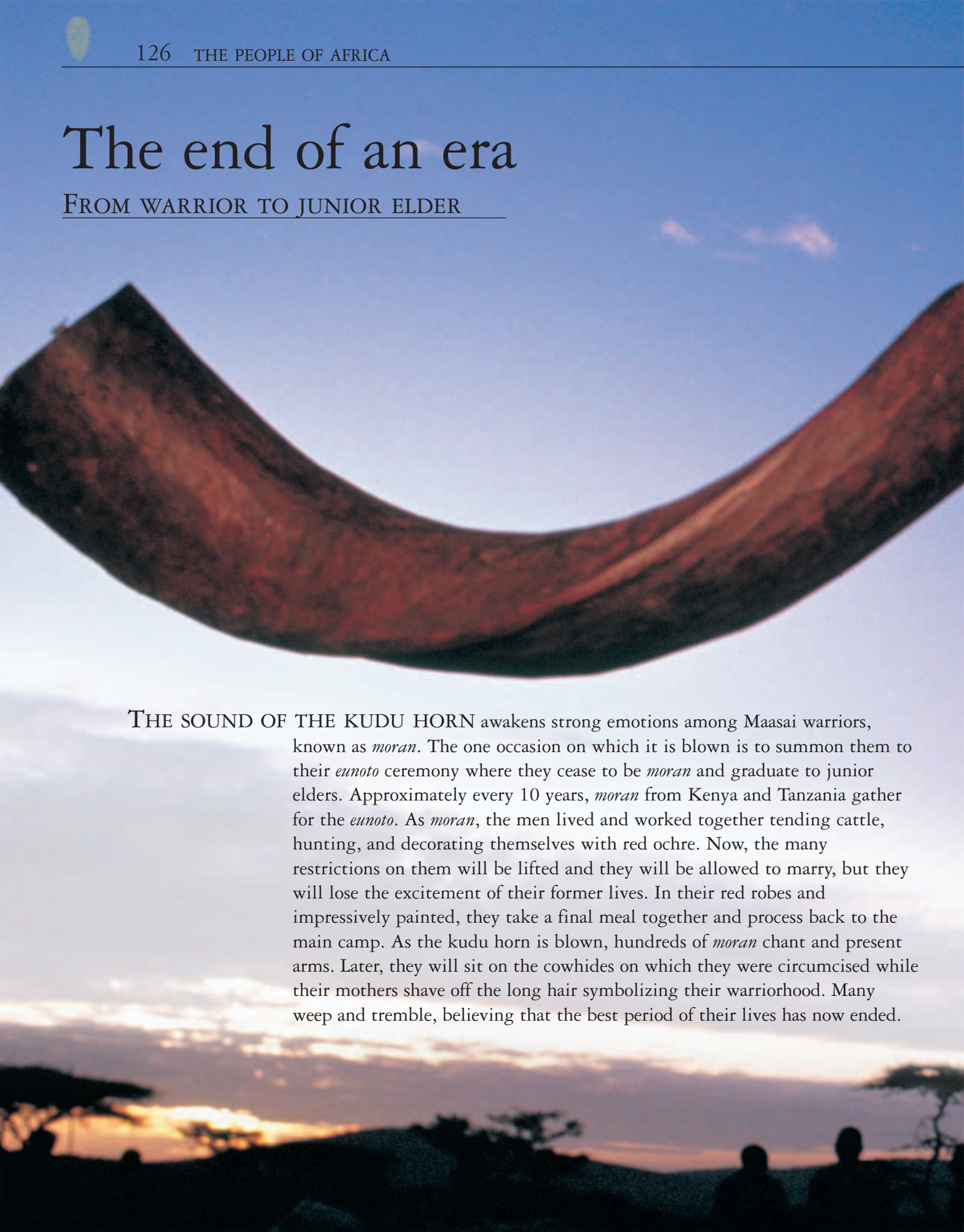




The end of an era

FROM WARRIOR TO JUNIOR ELDER



THE SOUND OF THE KUDU HORN awakens strong emotions among Maasai warriors, known as *moran*. The one occasion on which it is blown is to summon them to their *eunoto* ceremony where they cease to be *moran* and graduate to junior elders. Approximately every 10 years, *moran* from Kenya and Tanzania gather for the *eunoto*. As *moran*, the men lived and worked together tending cattle, hunting, and decorating themselves with red ochre. Now, the many restrictions on them will be lifted and they will be allowed to marry, but they will lose the excitement of their former lives. In their red robes and impressively painted, they take a final meal together and process back to the main camp. As the kudu horn is blown, hundreds of *moran* chant and present arms. Later, they will sit on the cowhides on which they were circumcised while their mothers shave off the long hair symbolizing their warriorhood. Many weep and tremble, believing that the best period of their lives has now ended.